VIP vehicles. The traffic officer who reached the spot for investigation asked the drivers of the vehicles to clear the area but got no response from them. He then issued a warning to them that their vehicles would be *challaned* if they did not do so. A photographer of a local newspaper was on the scene and he took a picture of the cars that were parked there. The picture showed even her boss's car, but it left just before the warning was issued.

The press played up the incident and, as in Delhi, so in Goa, Kiran was hauled up by the Chief Minister's Office. She was told to issue a correction to the press and to withdraw the police action. She refused point-blank, saying that if there were any clarifications to be sought they should be done from the Secretariat. The traffic police action, she maintained, was correct and any compromise on the initiative taken by the officer concerned would demoralize the entire force and stall the momentum created in traffic management and would make the force lose all the credibility it had striven so hard to build up in the eyes of the community. With some sort of a vague warning, she was curtly asked to leave.

The Goa administration had provided the SP (Traffic) with one old black Ambassador car and the deputy superintendent of police (DSP) with a jeep. The car was in a mess and since there was no DSP, Kiran got the jeep overhauled and had it painted white with fluorescent red stripes. A loudspeaker and a siren were mounted (just like during her Delhi days).

'The siren was not to clear the way for VIPs but for the common man, to feel good that we were on the road for him', she declared with her characteristic impish grin.

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The day Kiran reached Goa from Delhi, while on her way to Panjim from the airport, she had to cross the Zuari river by a ferry as the bridge over this river was not yet ready. (In Goa, light vehicles are transported by ferry.) A few months later, it was. However, it still remained closed for the public who continued to queue up to use the crowded ferry. The administration had been trying, desperately, to invite a VIP from Delhi to inaugurate the bridge but no confirmation of dates had been secured. The bridge therefore had to remain closed. Kiran was patrolling in the area one day and witnessed the usual sight of a huge snarl-up at the ferry boarding point. She decided to drive over the bridge and, with the help of her operator and driver, removed all the blockades and crossed over. She then diverted all the waiting traffic at the ferry over the bridge, thus 'inaugurating' it with a down-to-earth approach. The people of Goa loved her for this gesture. The VIPs were left wondering as to who opened the bridge for the public. The people knew who alone could have dared to do so. Kiran scripted a real-life story for the Goans by providing them with a 'permanent gift'. But, in the process, she also angered many in power. But for Kiran the convenience of the people mattered the most, whatever be the price.

'The bridge was "inaugurated" by a person on duty for whom the people always came first,' she says mock-sternly and then laughs, 'and today it does not have an inaugural stone and goes by its own name and not that of any VIP.' Obviously, the administration top brass realized it would make them look foolish if they reinaugurated the bridge. Surprisingly, this is one of the few incidents of its kind in her career where she was not directly hauled up by the bureaucrats or the politicians. She, however, gave them another chance.

The Exposition of St Francis Xavier's (1506–52) body used to be a momentous occasion for the Christian community of India. The body of the saint has been preserved in a reasonably good condition and was being exhibited to the public in a glass case on the occasion of the Exposition. Some years back, however, it was discovered that such exposure was adversely affecting the body